PRESS FACTSHEET · 4 NOVEMBER 2026

The Cyprus citizenship "culture exam": key facts

"Certification of Sufficient Knowledge of Basic Elements of the Contemporary Political and Social Reality of Cyprus for Third-Country Nationals", run by the Examination Service of the Ministry of Education. Every fact below carries its source number.

Who needs it	Third-country nationals applying for naturalisation (≥60%) or long-term resident status (≥50%) [1] [5]
Next sitting	**Saturday 21 November 2026**; applications were 5–12 October 2026 [2]
Sittings per year	Three, decided "because of the increased number of applicants" (22 Sep 2026) [2]
2027 dates	6 March (apply 11–18 Jan) · 3 July (apply 17–24 May) · 20 November (apply 4–11 Oct) [3]
Format	Multiple choice, 45 minutes, **Greek only** [1]; 25 questions, so 60% = 15 correct, as reported by Cyprus Mail [8]
Fee	€20, applications and payment only through JCC Smart [1][2]
Syllabus	14 topics (current affairs, history since 1960, customs, geography, political system, economy, entry conditions, telecoms, climate, languages and religions, currency, holidays, health and safety, transport). No sample questions are published [4]
Standard naturalisation	12 months' continuous residence + 7 years in the preceding 10, Greek B1, and this exam at ≥60% [5][6]
Fast track (since 19 Dec 2023)	Highly skilled employees of listed companies: 12 months + 3 years (Greek B1) or 4 years (Greek A2), and the same exam at ≥60% [5][6]; processing within 8 months on the fast track [7]
Application fees (naturalisation)	€500 on application, two €8.54 revenue stamps, and €500 on approval [5]
On exam day	ID card, passport or ARC plus the candidate card; no phones, smartwatches or dictionaries [9]

10 look-alike Greek term pairs

Why the Greek wording matters: the exam is written in Greek, and candidates hold B1 or A2 certificates [1][5]. Cyprus Mail's 19 July 2026 column described a question that turned on two near-identical terms (pair 1) [8].

#	Term A	Term B	Meaning
1	**Προεδρική δημοκρατία**	**Προεδρευόμενη δημοκρατία**	presidential republic (Cyprus) vs parliamentary republic with a ceremonial president (Greece) [8]
2	**Γενικός Εισαγγελέας**	**Γενικός Ελεγκτής**	Attorney-General vs Auditor-General
3	**Υπουργείο**	**Υφυπουργείο**	ministry vs deputy ministry (e.g. the Deputy Ministry of Shipping) [8]
4	**Πρόεδρος της Δημοκρατίας**	**Πρόεδρος της Βουλής**	President of the Republic vs President of the House
5	**Πραξικόπημα**	**Εισβολή**	coup vs invasion (both July 1974) [10]
6	**Ένταξη στην ΕΕ**	**Ευρώ**	EU accession (2004) vs adoption of the euro (2008) [8][10]
7	**Αγνοούμενοι**	**Εκτοπισμένοι**	missing persons vs displaced persons
8	**Κατεχόμενες περιοχές**	**Κυρίαρχες Περιοχές Βάσεων**	occupied areas vs the UK Sovereign Base Areas [10]
9	**Νόμιμο σημείο εισόδου**	**Παράνομο σημείο εισόδου**	legal vs illegal point of entry [8]
10	**Δήμος**	**Κοινότητα**	municipality (town) vs community (village)

Quote (attribute to "CyprusExamPrep"): "Most candidates know more about Cyprus than they think; it is the exam's Greek wording that trips them up. That is why our free test puts every question in Greek with the English and Russian side by side."

Free resource for readers: a free 15-question practice test in Greek with English and Russian translations, cyprus-exam-prep.github.io/?utm_source=press

[1] Ministry of Education, Examination Service: exam page (45 min, multiple choice, Greek, 50%/60%, €20 via JCC Smart): https://www.moec.gov.cy/ypexams/exams/pistopoiisi_eparkous_gnosis_vasikon_stoicheion_pragmatikotitas_kyprou.html
[2] Examination Service announcement, 22 Sep 2026: sitting 21 Nov 2026, applications 5–12 Oct 2026, three sittings a year: https://enimerosi.moec.gov.cy/archeia/1/ypp20532a
[3] Examination Service, 2027 programme (22 Sep 2026): 6 Mar, 3 Jul, 20 Nov 2027 and application windows: https://enimerosi.moec.gov.cy/archeia/1/ypp20531a
[4] Examination Service: official syllabus (14 topics): https://archeia.moec.gov.cy/mc/544/exetastea_yli_eparkis_gnosi_vasikon_stoicheion_pragmatikotitas_kyprou.pdf
[5] Ministry of Interior: naturalisation qualifications, form M127 (standard and highly-skilled routes; ≥60% certificate; fees): https://www.gov.cy/moi/en/documents/acquisition-of-cypriot-citizenship-by-naturalization-due-to-years-of-residence-form-m127/
[6] Civil Registry Law 141(I)/2002, s.111B (CyLaw): https://www.cylaw.org/nomoi/enop/ind/2002_1_141/section-sc5a59f6fe-c0fd-6b06-9d3f-952dbce6e858.html
[7] European Commission, Migration and Home Affairs: 'Cyprus: New citizenship legislation' (fast-track processing up to 8 months): https://home-affairs.ec.europa.eu/news/cyprus-new-citizenship-legislation-2024-03-06_en
[8] Cyprus Mail, Theo Panayides, 19 Jul 2026 (25 questions; 60% = 15; Greek wording): https://cyprus-mail.com/2026/07/19/trying-to-trick-people-with-cheap-gotchas-the-cyprus-citizenship-exam
[9] info.cy, 'Exams for long-term residence and Cypriot citizenship' (what to bring; centre and time sent by email): https://info.cy/cyprus-citizenship-and-residence-exams
[10] Press and Information Office, 'Cyprus at a Glance' (history dates): https://publications.gov.cy/assets/user/publications/GAAG/CAAG_EN_2018/CAAG_EN_2018.pdf

Independent project, not affiliated with the Ministry of Education or any government body. CyprusExamPrep · cyprusexamprep@gmail.com · cyprus-exam-prep.github.io · Media contact: cyprusexamprep@gmail.com